

So, this is day two of Allison and Andy's London trip. So, let's remember what we did. Let me think a moment, so day two and what that was all about. So, we decided that we wanted to go and visit the Victoria and Albert Museum. We hadn't been there before, having been to the other major museums, such as the Natural History, the Science Museum, and the British Museum. We had never been to the Victoria and Albert and were keen to go and take a look. So the first thing we did was checked out breakfast venues in that vicinity and we came across a very nice breakfast venue called Mary's Farm, which was on uh in Kensington, just on Exhibition Road where the museums are. So we got the tube, got up, we got out, we got ourselves ready. We walked down to King's Cross. We got the tube down to Kensington. We got out and we went to this little place for breakfast. It was absolutely gorgeous, really beautiful. Very great service. We sat outside, it was warm. Allison had two poached eggs on toast. I had some cinnamon and banana on sourdough bread with some delicious coffee and orange juice. We sat and just soaked up the warm warmth, watched the people going by as we had our breakfast. Really, really nice. Um, as we finished, it was perfect timing because the the V&A Museum opened at 10:00 a.m. So we walked up Exhibition Road. It was about four or five minute walk, turned right into the museum. And again, was very pleasantly surprised to learn it was free of entry, free entry, so we went in. And we were confronted by an enormous museum, multi-floor, huge array of different artifacts. Allison was a little taken aback, she thought it was more of a museum oriented towards design. But really it's just a history of all sorts of things of different periods in English history. So you know, you can go back to sort of Roman times, Anglo-Saxon, medieval, you know, and then later later on than that as well. And we were a bit overwhelmed by it to be honest. There were some unbelievable uh artifacts though. Like it sort of like on an absolutely colossal scale, like huge uh spiritual artifacts taken from churches, triptychs from the Catholic Church. On the most incredible scale. So it was quite um, or inspiring. Um, but we were a little bit lost in terms of having any particular focus or plan. So we wandered around for a bit. Kind of I looked up a couple of things were, you know, that were kind of V&A was famous for. One of which was the bed of wear, which is a three meter wide bed. There's a reference that goes all the way back to the 16th century and is referenced by Shakespeare in the 12th night. It is a very um, impressive looking large bed. And we also found something called the the Gloster Candle candle light, which I really must look up because that was also referenced. But we had a look at it. It was very sort of, you know, just that was a little bit underwhelming really but I should imagine it's got a phenomenal history which I shall have to look up. So we had a good look around the V&A. By the time we'd finished, our legs were getting a little bit weary so we sat down for a bit and decided to head into Kensington Gardens to explore the gardens there. So off we went. We um, we passed by the um, uh, Royal Albert Hall where I remembered going to watch a John Anderson concert when I was about 17. So quite some time ago. Allison's never been in the Royal Albert Hall. So we kind of vowed that we would return at some point and visit the Royal Albert Hall. At a future on a future visit. When when there's a something on that interests us or is appealing to us. We're also stunned by the size and the sort of majesty of the Prince Albert Memorial, not having seen that before or if I had, I I don't remember it. And considering its vastness, it's the spectacular nature of it. It's incredible the way London has got these things that sort of many other cities would be the main point of attraction, but for London it just blends into the background, it seems. But still fantastic. We had a nice walk around

Kensington Gardens. And we came to the Princess Diana Memorial, which we sort of, you know, wandered past respectfully, of course. And um eventually found a cafe near the Princess Diana Memorial where we sat. Ordered some more coffees and enjoyed reading our books. Again, it was nice and warm. Uh despite rain forecast actually, but it was it was actually a nice, very nice day. Anyway, we decided at this point that we would start thinking about the evening. Because in the evening we had booked to see a musical called Six. And it's a musical this has been running since it sort of came out in 2017, 2018 when some students from Cambridge in um created it, put it on at the Edinburgh Fringe. It's now on Broadway and the West End. And it's based around the six wives of King Henry VIII and we were due to see it at 7:00 p.m. at the Vaudeville Theater on the Strand later that day. And it was sort of about 2:00 p.m. So we decided that we would walk back to the um, back to our hotel. Not walk from Kensington Gardens, get the tube back to King's Cross, get something to eat, get to our hotel and then set off again. So that's what we did. We got the tube back. We got to King's Cross. We walked to our to a restaurant called Mildred's, which is famous for its vegan food, vegan menu. It was absolutely delicious. We both had a kind of, I had a kind of a Korean sticky chicken or fake chicken kind of meal with some fries and Allison had something kind of similar like a more of an American fried chicken type dinner meal. Again with some fries. Very nice drinks. Very, very nice. We got back to our room at the Crown Plaza Charing Cross. And when Allison, you know, we we just basically relaxed for about half an hour or so. I was actually fell asleep, read a book a bit, fell asleep, had a little bit of a doze, woke up again and um just, you know, and ready to set off for the for the show. So we got um we got the tube again. I think we got it to, it wasn't Piccadilly, it was somewhere near there. Um one of the tube stations near on near the Strand. I think it actually might have been Leicester Square we went to and we walked up to the Strand. And we found this lovely little hotel, lovely little pub, classic English sort of city, sort of London pub. Um I'll I'll remember the name later and fill it in later. Um but it was really, really nice. And it had these lovely little wooden booths that you could sit in. And uh so we sort of set in settled ourselves in. It was a Sam Smith's pub as well. Everything was all the drinks were sort of Sam Smith's drinks. And um Allison had like an Indian Pale Ale. I had a kind of a zero alcohol brown ale. All very nice. And then we we went in to watch Six the Musical. Now Six the Musical was very, very different to the previous evening in that it was an incredibly showy, jazzy, lively, energetic, colorful, full of energy. Lots of fun and humor and comedy and incredibly well performed by these six women, each playing one of the six wives of King Henry VIII. All I can say is that I personally was just enjoyed it from the beginning to the end. Uh it was 90 minutes, no interval. Um but it was just completely caught your attention and was very absorbing and very, very entertaining. And a really, you know, nice idea of sort of that the six wives were not given due credit for their uh kind of importance in history. It was all the attention goes on King Henry VIII, but without the six wives, he would have been nothing. It was the was one of the messages. But um really enjoyed it. We came out of there about it's only about 9:00, quarter past 9:00 when we came out of there. And we decided to walk up into Covent Garden, which we did. We decided we wanted an ice cream. So we found this little ice cream place. We went in and they offered, they they I I noticed they had small, regular and large on display, but I was offered regular or large. Small wasn't mentioned, so I resisted the temptation to have large and went, we both went for a regular. What then happened was that we got three just ginormous

scoops of this incredibly delicious ice cream. But with in cones that were laden with chocolate and sprinkled chopped nuts. It was absolutely vast this this ice cream. In fact, it was so so substantial as I was leaving, I was asked if I would like another container to put some of the ice cream in that was beginning to fall off the cone. Anyway, I declined and instead just sort of shoveled it all in my mouth as fast as possible. And Allison sort of she ate hers with a little bit more decorum. But in both cases, we finished off these huge ice creams, which cost about nine pounds each. So I think it might be one of the most expensive ice creams I've ever bought in a cone. But true, you know, fair to say, it was absolutely delicious, but we did feel somewhat like we'd eaten probably too much ice cream once we'd finished, but happy, uh, regardless. And we then, having finished our little tour around, little wander around common garden, we came across some street musicians who were as usual, Covent Garden standard, absolutely outstanding, playing the guitar, got a whole, you know, a couple of hundred people around, clapping, singing along. We watched that for a bit, really enjoyed it. And then we walked back down to Leicester Square. We got the tube back to King's Cross. And again walked back to our hotel room. Staggered to find that we had beaten yesterday's steps, which we thought was impossible to do. But again, the two steps was even more. I think it was like 23,000 and 20 23,000 for me and 25,000 for Allison. As a bit of a headline. I worked that out to be 9 and 1/2 miles by the way. And Allison confirmed that with her statistics on her phone. So um a a very enjoyable day. Lots of stuff packed in. Some learning at the VNA Museum, some relaxing at Kensington Garden. And some lovely food at Mildred's. And a fantastic musical classic sort of West End musical performance in the form of Six. A great day. That's the end of day two.